

01

Source-complete coverage ledger and answer-worthiness labels

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

Broad IKS revival is context only, not evidence for doctrine.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

Navya-Nyāya refinements, the pramāṇa–pramāṇaphala debate and detailed rival objections are CORE SUPPORTING DEPTH when tied to the question.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

Broad IKS revival is context only, not evidence for doctrine.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Broad IKS revival is context only, not evidence for doctrine.

ANSWER LINE: The seven categories, four pramāṇas, perception and inference, anyathākhyāti, self, apavarga, Īśvara, Udayana’s proofs, asatkāryavāda and atomism are CORE SYLLABUS.

02

Contemporary-anchor discipline

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

□ Search finding: A live August 2026 search located broad educational and academic discussion of Indian Knowledge Systems and classical Indian logic, but no sufficiently direct official doctrinal development specific to Nyāya–Vaiśeṣika.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

□□ Inference: Mention renewed interest in Indian logical traditions only as a bounded introduction or conclusion.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

Do not turn curriculum discussion into proof of a metaphysical or epistemological claim.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Do not turn curriculum discussion into proof of a metaphysical or epistemological claim.

ANSWER LINE: □ Search finding: A live August 2026 search located broad educational and academic discussion of Indian Knowledge Systems and classical Indian logic, but no sufficiently direct official doctrinal development specific to Nyāya–Vaiśeṣika.

03

Master distinction gateway

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

Master verdict: Nyāya–Vaiśeṣika is a realist system in which a detailed ontology is disclosed through valid cognition, error is a misrelation among real factors, and liberation follows removal of false knowledge.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

Master verdict: Nyāya–Vaiśeṣika is a realist system in which a detailed ontology is disclosed through valid cognition, error is a misrelation among real factors, and liberation follows removal of false knowledge.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

Memory line: seven categories prevent unlike kinds of reality from being confused.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

□ Its concern is not logic in an abstract formalist sense alone, but valid cognition as a means to the removal of error and finally liberation.

ANSWER LINE: Master verdict: Nyāya–Vaiśeṣika is a realist system in which a detailed ontology is disclosed through valid cognition, error is a misrelation among real factors, and liberation follows removal of false knowledge.